Gender roles

☞ **1** Use the word bank to complete the passage below.

Word bank					
maturity	fish	move	females	freshwater	Australia

Barramundi are f_____ that live in rivers, creeks and mangrove estuaries in northern A_____. They start life as males in the upper reaches of f_____ rivers and streams. They reach m_____ at around three to four years old, then m_____ downstream to coastal waters for spawning. At around five years old they change gender and become f_____.

2 What gender would the barramundi be at each point along the timeline below?



Months in the life of a barramundi

3 Use the word bank to complete the passage.

Word bank								
mate	males	become	bigger	birth	fertilises	unusual	female	birthing

Seahorses are unusual in the animal kingdom because it is the males that b_____ pregnant. They also choose to m_____ with only one partner, which is u_____ in fish species. The females are generally b_____ and more colourful than the m____ in order to attract a mate. Males have a b_____ pouch located below their chest area. The f_____ deposits her eggs inside the male's pouch, where he f_____ them. After two to three weeks he gives b_____ to the young.

4 Circle 'true' or 'false' for each of the following statements.

a) Male seahorses are bigger than female seahorses. True/False

b) The female deposits her eggs in the male's pouch. True/False

c) The female gives birth after three weeks. True/False

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